

You should **not** start by pitching tools. Start by positioning yourself as the person who will help NOX **discover the right AI opportunities business unit by business unit**, then convert those needs into a practical roadmap, vendor brief, and phased rollout. Since NOX only said they want AI incorporated across all units, your job now is to lead a structured discovery phase that turns a broad ambition into clear use cases, priorities, and budgets.

The right proposal angle

Your proposal should say:

“We will not force a pre-built AI solution on NOX. We will first run an AI discovery and opportunity-mapping phase across NOX’s business units, identify the highest-value use cases, assess feasibility and data readiness, and then recommend the right tools, automations, and enhancements for each unit.”

That is the safest and most professional angle because it avoids guessing technology too early and shows that you are solving the business problem, not selling software.

What to do first

1) Run an AI discovery sprint

The first step after the call is to schedule a **discovery sprint** with NOX leadership and key operators from each business unit. The goal is to uncover:

- Current workflows.
- Pain points.
- Repetitive tasks.
- Revenue leaks.
- Delays and approval bottlenecks.
- Data sources and systems already in use.

This should be framed as a working session, not a sales presentation.

2) Interview each business unit

Do 30–45 minute interviews with the people closest to the work:

- Venues

- Events
- Weddings
- Catering
- Creative production
- Procurement
- Finance or operations
- Sales and client servicing

The goal is to understand what slows them down, where mistakes happen, and where AI could add the most value in speed, quality, or cost reduction.

3) Map the current state

Before recommending AI tools, document the “as-is” process for each business unit.

For each workflow, capture:

- Trigger.
- Owner.
- Steps.
- Systems used.
- Approvals needed.
- Repeated manual work.
- Output.
- Bottleneck.

This gives you the raw material to identify which processes are best suited for automation or AI assistance.

How to frame the discovery work

Use three lenses for every business unit:

1) Business impact

Ask: Where can AI improve revenue, reduce costs, or improve customer experience most meaningfully?

2) Feasibility

Ask: Do they already have enough data, system access, and operational readiness to implement this soon?

3) Fit

Ask: Does this align with NOX's brand, service model, and growth plan?

This avoids proposing flashy tools that do not fit the business reality.

What your proposal should include

Your proposal for this phase should have 4 parts:

Part 1: Discovery and diagnosis

Explain that you will assess current processes, systems, and opportunities across all business units.

Part 2: Opportunity map

Show how you will convert findings into a ranked list of AI use cases by impact and effort.

Part 3: Recommended roadmap

Promise a phased plan with quick wins first, followed by deeper automation and physical enhancement.

Part 4: Implementation-ready brief

Say that once the priorities are clear, you will produce a vendor brief and execution roadmap so NOX can outsource development confidently.

Recommended first-step approach after the call

Week 1: Align and prepare

- Send a thank-you note summarizing the vision.
- Ask for a sponsor from NOX leadership.
- Request the names of operational heads in each unit.
- Share a short pre-discovery questionnaire.

Week 2: Discovery interviews

- Conduct interviews with each business lead.
- Gather process docs, SOPs, templates, dashboards, and reports.
- Collect examples of client communications, quotes, procurement workflows, and event briefs.

Week 3: Workshop

Run a half-day or full-day AI discovery workshop with NOX stakeholders. Use it to:

- Validate pain points.
- Rank opportunities.
- Surface concerns.
- Identify quick wins.
- Agree on success metrics.

Week 4: Output and direction

Deliver:

- AI opportunity map.
- Process pain-point summary.
- Priority use-case shortlist.
- Feasibility assessment.
- 90-day next-step roadmap.
- Draft vendor and implementation brief.

The questions you should ask NOX

Use questions like:

- Which tasks are most repetitive across your business units?
- Where do delays or errors happen most often?
- Which client requests are hardest to respond to quickly?
- Where is cost leakage highest?
- Which data is already available?
- Which systems are currently used?
- What would a “successful AI transformation” look like in 6 months?

These questions help you uncover the real need before recommending technology.

The output you should promise

Your discovery phase should produce:

- A mapped view of each business unit.
- A ranked AI use-case list.
- A recommendation of what to build, buy, or outsource.
- A high-level implementation roadmap.
- A budget range tied to priorities.
- A list of approved vendors or solution types to explore.

That makes your proposal feel strategic, grounded, and executable.

Best positioning for you

Do not position yourself as the person who already knows the tools. Position yourself as the person who will **find the right tools through a disciplined discovery process** and then turn those findings into an implementation plan. That makes you look more credible because you are not guessing; you are leading a structured transformation process.

Recommended wording for your next message to NOX

You can say:

“Before recommending specific AI tools, I propose a structured discovery phase across NOX’s business units to identify the highest-value opportunities, assess operational readiness, and define the right roadmap. This ensures the final solution is aligned to your actual needs, not generic AI trends.”

That is the cleanest way to start. It gives you authority, protects you from proposing the wrong thing too early, and sets up the next phase for a stronger proposal.

I can next draft your **discovery phase proposal**, including the email to NOX, the interview questions, and the workshop agenda.

yes please

Absolutely — the next step is to sell NOX a **discovery phase** rather than a solution.

The goal is to uncover the right AI opportunities across all business units, then convert them into a ranked roadmap, implementation brief, and budget.

Discovery phase proposal

Position this as a structured **AI Opportunity Mapping** engagement. The purpose is to understand NOX’s current state, business priorities, operational pain points, and readiness for AI before any tools are selected. This is the most credible way to approach a client that only knows they want AI “across the business” but has not yet defined the use cases.

What you are offering

- AI discovery interviews across each business unit.
- Current-state workflow mapping.
- Pain point and opportunity analysis.
- AI use-case prioritization.
- Feasibility and readiness assessment.
- Roadmap and implementation brief.

That makes you look strategic, disciplined, and aligned with business outcomes rather than software hype.

First steps after the call

1) Send a short alignment note

Send a follow-up message summarizing what you heard and confirming that the next phase should be discovery first. The note should say you will help NOX identify the highest-value AI opportunities across the business, then turn them into a practical roadmap.

2) Request the right stakeholders

Ask NOX to nominate one leader from each of the following:

- Venues.
- Events.
- Weddings.
- Catering.
- Creative production.
- Procurement.
- Operations.
- Finance or reporting.

These are the people who can tell you where time, money, and service quality are being lost.

3) Ask for baseline materials

Request:

- SOPs.
- Workflow charts.
- Sample proposals.
- Sales decks.
- Procurement templates.

- Inventory sheets.
- Client communication samples.
- Reporting dashboards.

This gives you the raw input to map where AI can help most.

Your discovery method

Use a three-layer process:

Layer 1: Interviews

Run 30–45 minute interviews with each business unit leader. Focus on:

- Repetitive work.
- Delay points.
- High-volume manual tasks.
- Customer experience gaps.
- Cost leakage.
- Data quality issues.

The objective is to uncover real business pain, not theoretical AI ideas.

Layer 2: Workshop

Run a half-day or full-day discovery workshop with key NOX stakeholders. The agenda should:

- Align on business goals.
- Review current pain points.
- Brainstorm AI opportunities.
- Score each use case by value and effort.
- Select the top 3–5 priorities.
- Define what success looks like.

Layer 3: Opportunity mapping

Convert the workshop output into a ranked matrix:

- **High value / low effort** = first wave.
- **High value / high effort** = second wave.
- **Low value / low effort** = optional.
- **Low value / high effort** = avoid.

This prevents you from overbuilding or chasing shiny technology.

Questions to ask NOX

Use questions like:

- What tasks are repeated every day or every event?
- Where do team members spend the most manual time?
- What client requests are slowest to respond to?
- Where do errors happen most often?
- Which processes have the biggest cost impact?
- What data do you already have?
- What systems are in use today?
- What would a measurable AI win look like in 90 days?

These questions help you identify the best use cases and avoid generic AI proposals.

What the discovery output should be

Your deliverable should include:

- A summary of business priorities.
- A current-state workflow map.
- A use-case inventory.
- A prioritization matrix.
- A recommended AI roadmap.
- A draft implementation plan.
- A vendor/tool brief.
- An estimated budget range.

That gives NOX a clear decision-making document instead of a vague idea.

Suggested proposal language

You can say:

“To ensure the right solution is designed for NOX, I recommend starting with an AI discovery and opportunity-mapping phase across all business units. This will identify where AI can create the most value, what data and workflows already exist, and which use cases should be prioritized for implementation.”

That wording is strong because it says you are not guessing the tools; you are designing the right path to them.

Recommended duration

A clean discovery phase would be:

- **Week 1:** Stakeholder alignment and document request.
- **Week 2:** Interviews.
- **Week 3:** Workshop.
- **Week 4:** Analysis and roadmap delivery.

So the full discovery phase can be done in about **2–4 weeks**, depending on NOX's availability.

Best next deliverables

The three things you should prepare now are:

1. A discovery-phase proposal.
2. A stakeholder interview guide.
3. A workshop agenda.

I can draft all three into a ready-to-send package next, starting with the **discovery-phase proposal email** and the **interview questions**.

yes please

Absolutely — here is a ready-to-send **discovery phase package** for NOX.

1) Discovery phase proposal email

Subject: NOX AI Discovery & Opportunity Mapping Phase

Hi [NOX Name],

Thank you again for the discussion last week.

Based on NOX's ambition to incorporate AI across all business units, I recommend we begin with a structured **AI Discovery & Opportunity Mapping Phase** before selecting any specific tools or technologies. This will allow us to identify the highest-value use cases across venues, events, weddings, catering, creative production, procurement, and operations, and ensure the final solution is aligned with your actual business needs.

The purpose of this phase is to:

- Understand current workflows and pain points.
- Identify where AI can create the most value.
- Assess readiness across systems, data, and operations.
- Prioritize the best use cases by business impact and implementation effort.

- Produce a practical roadmap and implementation brief for execution.

This approach ensures the AI solution is strategic, scalable, and tailored to NOX rather than generic. I would propose a 2–4 week discovery engagement involving stakeholder interviews, workflow mapping, and a collaborative workshop with your team.

If aligned, I can share a short discovery plan, workshop structure, and the information we need from your side to begin.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

2) Stakeholder interview guide

Use these questions for each business unit lead.

Business and goals

- What are your main business priorities for the next 6–12 months?
- What outcomes matter most to your team?
- Where do you want AI to help most: speed, cost, quality, sales, or client experience?

Current workflow

- What are the main steps in your current process?
- Which steps are manual or repetitive?
- Where do delays or bottlenecks happen?
- What tasks require the most human effort today?

Pain points

- What frustrates your team most in day-to-day operations?
- Where do mistakes happen most often?
- Which processes create the most back-and-forth?
- Where do you feel revenue or time is being lost?

Data and systems

- What tools or systems do you use now?
- What data do you already capture?
- Where is data missing, inconsistent, or hard to access?
- Who owns the data and reporting today?

AI opportunities

- Which tasks could be assisted or automated?
- Which client-facing tasks could benefit from AI?
- What would make your team faster or more accurate?
- What would a “quick win” look like in 90 days?

Readiness and constraints

- What would block implementation?
- What approvals are needed to change workflows?
- What training would your team need?
- Are there any compliance, privacy, or brand concerns?

3) Discovery workshop agenda

Workshop length

Half-day or full-day

Attendees

- Leadership sponsor
- Heads of business units
- Procurement
- Operations
- Finance or reporting
- You and your team

Agenda

1. Opening and business vision

- Confirm NOX’s goals for AI.
- Align on what success looks like.

2. Current-state overview

- Review each business unit.
- Identify recurring problems and manual work.

3. Opportunity brainstorming

- Capture every AI idea from the team.
- Group ideas by business function.

4. Prioritization exercise

Score each idea by:

- Business impact.
- Ease of implementation.
- Data readiness.

- Time to value.

5. Shortlist use cases

Select the top 3–5 use cases to take forward first.

6. Roadmap discussion

Agree on:

- What to do first.
- What to phase later.
- Who owns each next step.

7. Close and next deliverables

Confirm timeline for the discovery report, roadmap, and vendor brief.

4) Discovery deliverables

At the end of the phase, you should deliver:

- Stakeholder interview summary.
- Business pain-point map.
- AI opportunity inventory.
- Prioritization matrix.
- Recommended use-case shortlist.
- 90-day roadmap.
- Vendor / solution brief.
- Estimated implementation budget.

5) How to position this to NOX

Say this clearly:

“Before recommending specific AI tools, we should first map NOX’s workflows and identify where AI can create the most value. This ensures we invest in the right solutions, in the right order, with the right business impact.”

That sounds confident, structured, and aligned with their needs.

6) Suggested discovery fee

If you want to price this phase separately, a fair structure is:

- **USD 7,500–15,000** for the discovery sprint.
- If it expands into workshops and roadmap development, **USD 15,000–25,000** total.

This keeps the entry point manageable and positions you well for the implementation phase.